

EXPERIMENT 5

Building Reports, Dashboards and Custom Pages for the Application in Zoho Creator

Bank Loan Application System – Loan Applications, Liabilities & Dashboard Use Case

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Aim

To design and build functional reports, a dashboard, and a consolidated custom page in Zoho Creator that organise and visualise the applicant data captured by the Loan_Application_Form, enabling the lending and front-office team to monitor applicant liabilities, loan-type distribution, and overall application volume at a glance.

The exercise extends the previously built Loan_Application_Form into a reporting layer, so that the raw records captured during application intake become directly usable by staff for daily monitoring, without requiring any manual export or spreadsheet work.

Problem Statement

The Loan_Application_Form captures every new loan application in a structured record — personal details, employment information, monthly income, and existing liabilities — but the lending team still has no consolidated way to review this data. Scanning submissions one record at a time makes it difficult to see how many applicants fall under each liability category, or to get a quick, searchable master list of every applicant received so far.

As the number of applications grows, front-office staff need a way to triage applicants by their existing liabilities before further processing, and the lending team needs a single screen that summarises volume and risk exposure without opening the underlying form records one at a time.

Design a reporting and analytics layer on top of the existing application data that lets staff view submissions grouped by existing-liability type, and lets the lending team see, at a glance, how many applicants hold vehicle loans, home loans, personal loans, or no liabilities at all — all through a native Zoho Creator List Report and a consolidated Dashboard page.

Software / Platform Used

- Zoho Creator (low-code application development platform)
- Zoho Creator Deluge scripting for widget data-source configuration
- Native Zoho Creator List Report and Dashboard builder components

- Web browser (for previewing the live form, report, and dashboard)

Procedure

1. Log into Zoho Creator and open the existing "Bank Loan Application System" application, which contains the Loan_Application_Form built in the earlier experiment.
2. Create a List Report named "Liabilities" on the Loan_Application_Form and group records by the Existing_Liabilities field so submissions appear under Vehicle Loan, Home Loan, and No Liabilities columns.
3. Configure each Liabilities column card to display the applicant's First Name and Last Name so staff can scan the pipeline without opening each record.
4. Create a Dashboard page and add four count widgets sourced from the same form: Total Vehicle Loans, Count of Home Loan, Count of No Liabilities, and Total Personal Loans.
5. Add a search bar (Enter First Name) and an "All Loan Applications" list report to the Dashboard, with columns for First Name, Last Name, PAN Number, Email, Contact Number, and Address, so the full applicant list is visible alongside the summary counts.
6. Configure each widget's data source and count field, and set report and dashboard permissions so front-office staff can view but not edit the configuration.
7. Preview the live Loan Application form, the Liabilities report, and the Dashboard; verify that the sample applicant records render correctly in every widget and that the search bar and liability tabs update the record list as expected.

Throughout the procedure, no new form fields or data tables were introduced — every report, widget, and list view reads directly from the existing Loan_Application_Form record set, keeping the application data model unchanged while adding a purely presentational analytics layer on top of it.

Data Model

This exercise does not introduce a new data table; the Liabilities report and the Dashboard both read from the same Loan_Application_Form record set. The List Report (Liabilities) presents these records grouped by Existing_Liabilities. The Dashboard aggregates the same records into count widgets keyed on Existing_Liabilities, and combines them with a searchable All Loan Applications list so the lending team does not need to navigate between separate report and dashboard pages during daily review.

Because every component is a view over the same underlying record set, any new application submitted through the Loan_Application_Form automatically appears in the Liabilities report, updates the relevant count widget, and is searchable from the All Loan Applications list — with no additional configuration required per record.

Report & Dashboard Structure

Section	Key Components	Purpose
List Report	Liabilities, grouped by Existing_Liabilities	Provides a filterable, liability-type grouped view of every applicant for quick lending-team lookup.
Dashboard – Summary Counts	Total Vehicle Loans, Count of Home Loan, Count of No Liabilities, Total Personal Loans	Summarises how many applicants fall under each existing-liability category at a glance.
Dashboard – Applications Overview	Search bar (by First Name), All Loan Applications list	Gives the lending team a searchable master list of every applicant received so far.

Report, Dashboard and Component Mapping

The table below maps every reporting component built in this exercise to its configured name, purpose, and a sample insight it surfaces.

Component	Name	Purpose	Sample Insight
List Report	Liabilities	Displays every submitted application grouped into Vehicle Loan / Home Loan / No Liabilities columns.	Records spread across 3 liability columns
Count Widget	Total_Vehicle_Loans	Counts applicants who hold an existing vehicle loan.	1 applicant
Count Widget	Count_of_Home_Loan	Counts applicants who hold an existing home loan.	1 applicant
Count Widget	Count_of_No_Liabilities	Counts applicants who report no existing liabilities.	1 applicant
Count Widget	Total_Personal_Loans	Counts applicants who hold an existing personal loan.	1 applicant
List Report	All_Loan_Applications	Combines every submitted application into one searchable master table with a First-Name search bar.	Showing 4 of 4 records
Dashboard Page	Dashboard	Combines the summary count widgets, search bar, and applications list into one consolidated screen.	Front-office daily-use screen

Advantages of the Reporting & Dashboard Layer

- Gives the lending team a single consolidated screen instead of scanning individual applicant records one at a time.
- Groups applicants by liability type automatically, making risk-category triage immediate rather than manual.
- The searchable All Loan Applications list lets any staff member locate an applicant instantly by First Name.
- Count widgets update live as new applications are submitted, with no manual recalculation needed.
- View-only permissions on reports and dashboard protect the underlying configuration from accidental changes by front-office staff.

Applications

- Daily monitoring of incoming loan applications by front-office and lending teams.
- Quick identification of applicants with existing vehicle, home, or personal loans before further credit assessment.
- A searchable master directory of applicants for customer-service lookups.
- A template pattern that can be extended to other Zoho Creator forms needing grouped reports and summary dashboards.

Report

1. The Loan Application Form

The screenshot shows the 'Loan Application' form in the 'Bank Loan Application System'. The form is titled 'Loan Application' and contains the following fields:

- First Name: LOHITH
- Last Name: C
- PAN Number: 6868954
- Email: lohith.c.2024.csbs@rajalakshmi
- Contact Number: +91 09840384845
- Address: Vellore - Chennai Rd, Rajalakshmi
- Date Of Birth: 08-Oct-2006
- Employment Type: Salaried (selected)
- Monthly Income: 75000
- Existing Liabilities: Home Loan

At the bottom of the form, there are two buttons: 'Submit' and 'Reset'.

Fig. 1 – Loan Application form

2. The Liabilities Report (Grouped by Liability Type)

The screenshot shows the 'Liabilities' report in the 'Bank Loan Application System'. The report is titled 'Liabilities' and is grouped by liability type. The report has three columns: 'Vehicle Loan', 'Home Loan', and 'No Liabilities'. Each column contains a list of liabilities.

Vehicle Loan	Home Loan	No Liabilities
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P	C	A

Fig. 2 – Liabilities report, grouped by Existing Liabilities

3. The Dashboard – Loan Overview & All Applications

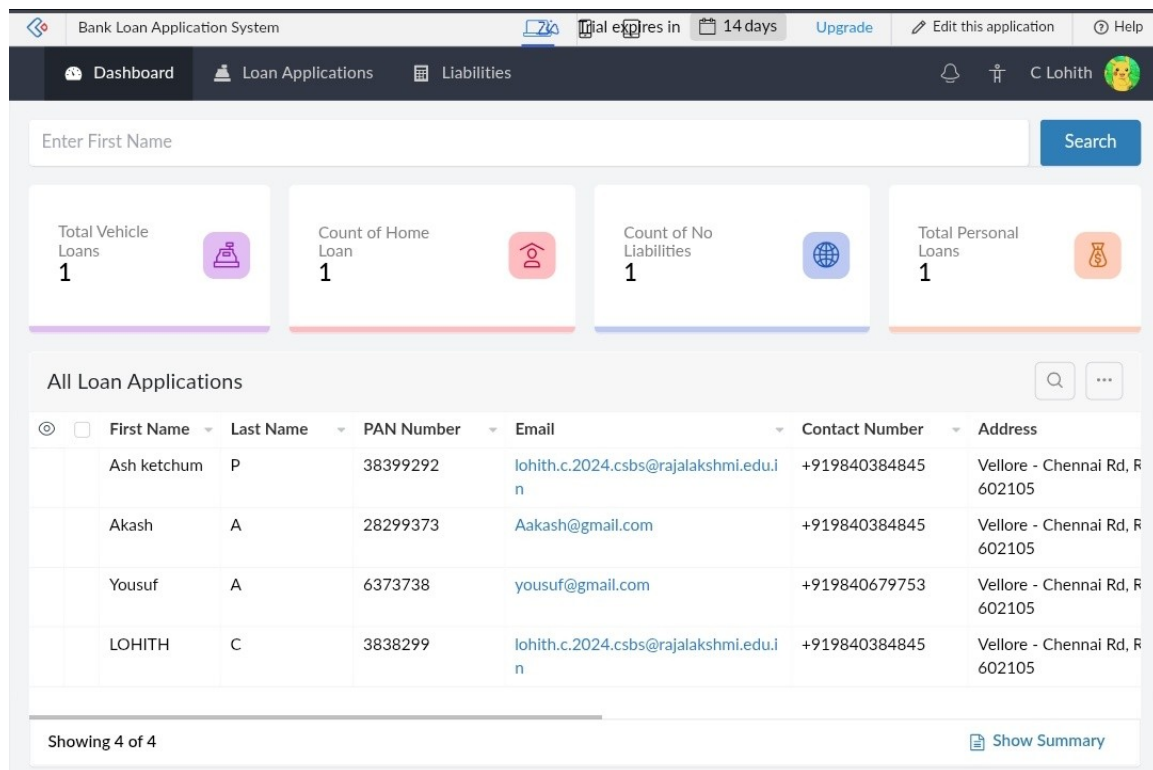


Fig. 3 – Dashboard, showing summary counts and all loan applications

Learning Outcome

This exercise reinforced how a low-code platform such as Zoho Creator can turn a single form's records into multiple purpose-built views — a grouped list report for triage and a dashboard for summary monitoring — without duplicating data or building any new backend logic.

It also demonstrated how count widgets, search components, and list reports can be composed on one dashboard page to give different stakeholders (front-office staff vs. the lending team) the exact slice of information they need from the same underlying dataset.

Result

The Liabilities report and Dashboard for the Bank Loan Application System were successfully designed and implemented in Zoho Creator on top of the existing Loan_Application_Form. The Liabilities report groups every submission by Existing_Liabilities into Vehicle Loan, Home Loan, and No Liabilities columns, and the Dashboard visualises applicant counts by liability type alongside a searchable All Loan Applications list. Sample applicant records were verified across every report and dashboard view, demonstrating a functional analytics layer for the lending team's daily operations.

Conclusion

The Bank Loan Application System now offers front-office and lending staff a complete, self-service reporting layer: a grouped Liabilities report for quick risk-category scanning, and a consolidated Dashboard combining summary counts with a searchable master list of applicants. Both views stay automatically in sync with new form submissions, fulfilling the goal of giving staff visibility into applicant liabilities and application volume without manual data handling.